

The blue whale is a baleen whale. It takes huge gulps of seawater and filters out the small fish and krill.



A shark-sized snack

A blue whale may be big, but its size doesn't stop sharks and orcas from attacking it. This whale has lost a little bit of one of its tail flukes.

A big mouth

The blue whale's mouth is massive. Between 55 and 70 skin grooves or pleats run along the lower half from throat to midbody. These expand when the whale gulps in its food.

90 ft (27 m) and weigh the same as 26 adult bull elephants.

Early whalers called the blue whale "sulfur bottom." Algae growing on its belly can make it appear yellow – the color of sulfur.